U3 Pioneering progress: A dynamic world

Unit overview

Fostering continuous growth in a dynamic world is a challenge faced by all governments in the world. China has emerged as a pioneer in addressing the issue through decades of reform and opening up. This unit first explores China's reform and opening up from both historical and contemporary perspectives. In Understanding China, a video briefly reviews China's reform and opening-up process and achievements since 1978. Following this, the reading material highlights China's continuous efforts to meet the new challenges in this ever-changing world. With the Free Trade Port initiative, Hainan stands at the forefront of China's new round of reform and opening up in the new era. The unit also showcases the explorations and efforts for growth in other countries. The reading material in Exploring the World examines how African countries are making collective efforts to construct a single continental market under the African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA). In Communicating with the world, Ss are guided to give an expository speech at the opening ceremony of a study tour to introduce China's reform and opening up, as well as the Hainan FTP. This can deepen their understanding of why reform and opening up is a major reason for China's dramatic growth, and why it is a key move that determines the success of Chinese modernization.

校园资料仓

思政元素清单

Understanding China — Viewing

- 改革开放是决定当代中国命运的关键一招。
- 兴办经济特区是探索中国特色社会主义道路的重大举措。
- 加入 WTO 融入全球经济体系改变了中国经济的面貌，也推动了全球化进程的发展。

Understanding China — Reading

- 全面深化改革开放，为中国式现代化持续注入强劲动力。
- 海南自贸区建设是我国深化改革开放的一个重大举措，是探索和推进更高水平开放的战略选择。

Exploring the world — Reading

- 非洲大陆自贸区促进非洲各国间贸易便利化和自由化，为促进开放型世界经济的发展注入新动能。

单元开篇

Quote

要进一步深化改革开放。改革开放是当代中国大踏步赶上时代的重要法宝，是决定中国式现代化成败的关键一招。

——2023 年 12 月 26 日，习近平在纪念毛泽东同志诞辰 130 周年座谈会上的讲话

Key facts about China

The key facts in this unit highlight the great strides China has made as part of the government's reform and opening-up policy, showing China's economic transformation, growing global influence, and increased openness. The implications of the selected key facts are:

Key fact 1: The staggering growth of China's GDP is one of the most remarkable economic transformations in modern history. It highlights the effectiveness of China's economic reforms and policies since 1978. The rapid growth in GDP has led to a quantum leap in the quality of life of the population and remarkable progress across all sectors of society.

Key fact 2: The dramatic increase in China's foreign trade demonstrates China's central role in international supply chains and its strong economic ties with countries all over the world, which is a direct result of China's reform and opening up. As a major driver of the global economy, China now has a significant influence over global trade policies, standards, and practices.

Key fact 3: The extension of visa-free transit stays reflects China's commitment to openness. The policy shows China's soft power and its goodwill to other countries. The significant increase in inbound foreign visits allows more international visitors to learn about China and helps to dispel existing stereotypes.

***T can guide Ss to access the digital textbook for the latest information and data on Ucampus.**

Teaching suggestions

Step 1: The unit theme can be introduced with a translation exercise. Ask Ss to translate the following sayings. Comment on Ss' translation, and point out that these are the popular sayings from the early days of China's reform and opening up.

校园资料仓

A. 实践是检验真理的唯一标准 B. 不管黑猫白猫，捉到老鼠就是好猫 C. 科学技术是第一生产力 D. 摸着石头过河	a) Practice is the sole criterion for testing the truth. b) As long as a cat catches mice, it's a good cat, whether black or white. c) Science and technology are the primary productive forces. d) Cross the river by feeling the stones.

Step 2: Guide Ss to share their knowledge of the major processes of the reform and opening up China has gone through.

Step 3: Guide Ss to read the quote of the unit. Invite Ss to briefly share their understanding of "decisive move," "catch up with the times," and "crucial to the success of Chinese modernization."

Step 4: Lead Ss to read the key facts and discuss the implications of each fact. Help Ss understand the staggering growth China has achieved.

Step 5: Introduce the Scenario section and the unit objectives. Discuss what knowledge and skills are needed for the completion of the project.

校园资料会

Understanding China

The two materials in this section examine China's reform and opening up, offering insights into both its historical development and recent advancements. The Viewing section outlines China's reform and opening-up process by reviewing the three major steps: the 1978 reform decision (the starting point), the establishment of special export zones (a major strategy), and WTO entry (a milestone), providing Ss with a clear understanding of this historical progression. The text in this section probes into China's reform and opening up in the new era. It takes the Hainan FTP as an example and illustrates the country's efforts to strengthen the reform and opening up in the new era.

Today's young people might not find it easy to understand why setting economic development as a priority is a historic decision and how difficult it was for China to join the WTO. Lack of background knowledge might also make it difficult to understand expressions like "urgent need to catch up" and "class struggles."

When teaching the text, the focus is to help Ss "sense" China's determination and efforts to deepen reform and keep the openness in the new international landscape, and "see" the initial achievements and potential outcomes. The text is a good example of effectively narrating China's story. Its use of situation-based narratives, which combine precise time markers, specific locations, and detailed descriptions, creates vivid scenarios that engage audiences and enhance understanding. A key difficulty in teaching the text is guiding Ss to apply what they learn from this text – language knowledge, IC skills, and storytelling strategies – in their project as well as in real-world international communication contexts.

校园资料仓

Viewing

Before viewing

Sample answers

1

Back to the early 1980s, Shekou was undeveloped, with low-rise buildings, open land, and a rough industrial feel. Fast forward to the 2020s, and it's a completely different world – towering skyscrapers, modern roads, green spaces, and a well-planned waterfront. What was once a quiet fishing and industrial area is now a buzzing urban hub with dense housing and commercial districts.

This huge transformation comes down to China's reform and opening-up policy, which turned Shenzhen into a Special Economic Zone and brought in businesses, investment, and rapid industrial growth. With strong government support, an open and dynamic market environment, and a wave of talent moving in for job opportunities, Shekou quickly became a high-tech and commercial hotspot. With smart city planning and cutting-edge technology, it's no surprise the area has evolved into a global hub.

Scripts

In 1978, Deng Xiaoping visited Japan.

For the first time, Deng experienced the momentum of Japan's high-speed railway.

"This feels fast. Almost felt [feels] like we are urged to run. This kind of transportation is just [what] we need at this moment," Deng said.

Deng's thoughts about the Shinkansen revealed his belief in China's urgent need to catch up.

Between 1978 and 1979, Deng paid visits to many foreign states. After witnessing the standard of living in developed countries, the CPC leadership vowed to concentrate all efforts on economic development and lead China to build a modernized society. Deng once said, "We consult good practices from all developed nations. We also consult good practices from all Third World nations."

In 1978, the Third Plenary Session of the 11th Central Committee of the Communist Party of China was held in Beijing. This meeting set the foundation for the CPC to lead China in achieving the important economic transition of reform and opening up. During the session, the CPC leadership shifted the country's priority from class struggles to economic development.

"The Third Plenary Session of the 11th Central Committee of the CPC has gone down in history as a great turnaround in the history of the CPC. The most crucial achievement of that meeting was the decision to reform and open up."

One year after the Third Plenary Session, the CPC leadership approved setting up special export zones in Shenzhen, Zhuhai, Shantou, and Xiamen, allowing freer exports and trade in these selected areas. Later, they were given more policy support, such as tax reduction and encouragement on foreign investments, and are now known as special economic zones. Bold reform practices were tested in these zones, and the successful ones were promoted across the nation. After four decades, the most well-known example, Shenzhen, has become an innovative cosmopolitan city, which is home to many of China's most successful tech companies.

Another key step for opening up was the CPC's timely decision to join the World Trade Organization. In 1986, China submitted a request to regain its status in the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade, which later transformed into the WTO. With great perseverance, China managed to join the WTO after a 15-year-long negotiation. It injected China with a power boost toward globalization. A market with a population of over one billion people opened itself to the world. By 2013, China became the largest trading country and it contributed to over 30 percent of the world's total economic growth during the period between 2012 and 2016. "Made in China" had swept the world.

校园资料仓

"The opening up of China's economy is about more than just its own development. It means developing together with other countries, and sharing the achievements of China's advancement with them. Good relationships with neighbors are important, but it's also crucial for these neighbors to prosper as well. That's why the opening up of China's economy is not just important for China, but for the whole world."

The CPC's commitment to catch up was realized through the process of reform and opening up, and China committed to sharing its development with the rest of the world. The key to this economic miracle is the CPC's decision to keep an open mind, which as people say in Chinese, *fang de kai*. Just like President Xi Jinping said, "For a country, opening up is like the struggle of a chrysalis breaking free from its cocoon. There will be short-term pains, but such pains will create a new life."

Notes

1 To test the reform and opening-up policies, Deng Xiaoping proposed the idea of "**special export zone**（出口特区）," and four pilot special export zones in Shenzhen, Zhuhai, Shantou, and Xiamen were established in 1979. In 1980, the four pilot zones were renamed "special economic zone（经济特区）."

2 A **special economic zone (SEZ)** is a special area in a country where different or more favorable economic regulations are applied to attract foreign investment and generate economic growth. In 1980, China renamed the four pilot "special export zones" to "special economic zones." In April 1988, the Hainan Special Economic Zone was established as another special economic zone in China, and in May 2010, Xinjiang's Horgos and Kashi were added to the list. These SEZs adopt special economic policies and management systems to develop an export-oriented economy. They are major channels for China to boost its own economy by utilizing overseas capital, technology, personnel, and management expertise, and are windows to and models of China's reform and opening up, driving socialist modernization.

3 The **World Trade Organization (WTO)** is a global organization that regulates and facilitates global trade. It provides a framework for negotiating trade agreements, resolving disputes between participating members, and ensuring trade flows smoothly, predictably, and freely. Headquartered in Geneva, Switzerland, this world's largest international economic organization has 166 members representing over 98 percent of global trade and global GDP. Through negotiated agreements, the WTO reduces trade barriers, such as tariffs and quotas, enabling goods, services, and investments to flow more freely across borders. This has significantly facilitated globalization, encouraging economic interdependence, expanding markets for businesses, and integrating developing countries into the global economy.

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4 The **General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT)** was a multilateral agreement initially signed in 1947 by 23 contracting parties to reduce trade barriers and promote international trade and economic recovery after World War II. In 1995, GATT was replaced by the WTO. China participated decisively in the founding of GATT and officially became a contracting party to GATT on May 21, 1948. In 1986, China applied for the resumption of its membership in GATT, and ultimately acceded to the WTO on December 11, 2001, after 15 years of complex negotiations.

*** T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 For the first time, Deng experienced the momentum of Japan's high-speed railway. (Para. 2)

momentum: *n*. [U]

1) the force that makes a moving object keep moving （使运动物体继续运动的）冲力，推力，动力
The rocket's engine provided enough momentum to propel it into space.

2) the ability to keep increasing, developing, or being more successful 动力；势头
The athlete's early victories in the tournament gave her the momentum to continue performing at her best.

Note: In this sentence, "momentum" refers to the impressive force, speed, and progress of Japan's high-speed railway. It conveys not just the physical motion of the train but also the broader sense of technological and economic advancement that the railway represented.

2 With great perseverance, China managed to join the WTO after a 15-year-long negotiation. (Para. 9)

perseverance: *n*. [U] determination to keep trying to achieve sth. in spite of difficulties 不屈不挠；坚持不懈
Despite facing numerous setbacks, she achieved her goal through perseverance and hard work.

3 It injected China with a power boost toward globalization. (Para. 9)

inject: *vt.*

1) add sth. new to a situation 注入；增添
The coach tried to inject some enthusiasm into the team before the big game.

2) put liquid, esp. a drug, into one's body by using a special needle 注射（尤指药

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物）

The doctor had to inject the patient with painkillers to ease the discomfort after surgery.

Note: In this context, "power boost" refers to a significant source of energy, momentum, or support that propels China forward in its journey toward globalization. It implies a strong enhancement or acceleration of China's ability to engage with and integrate into the global economy and international community.

4 Just like President Xi Jinping said, "For a country opening up is like the struggle of a chrysalis breaking free from its cocoon. …" (Para. 11)

Note: The phrase "the struggle of a chrysalis breaking free from its cocoon" is a metaphor comparing a difficult process of reform and opening up to the struggle of a chrysalis (a pupa) emerging from its cocoon. It suggests that the process is challenging and requires effort, but it is also necessary for growth and transformation – just as a butterfly must struggle to break free in order to develop strong wings and survive. The underlying idea is that hardship and struggle are often essential parts of progress and success.

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Viewing and understanding

Reference answers

2

1) economic development
2) reform and opening up
3) exports and trade
4) tax reduction
5) reform practices
6) globalization.
7) achievements
8) an open mind

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

Step 1: Guide Ss to read through the IC skill explanation. Draw their attention to the strategy of "breaking down complex concepts." Encourage them to brainstorm additional ways a complex concept can be simplified beyond subtopics and stages. For example, consider breaking it down into categories or key elements.

Step 2: Lead Ss to discuss the features of "simple language." Guide them to identify more examples of simplified language from the video. For example, in the sentence "China became the largest trading country and it contributed to over 30 percent of the world's total economic growth," rather than presenting the complex total value of China's foreign trade, the video uses a simple percentage to highlight China's global influence.

Step 3: Guide Ss to discuss other possible strategies for simplification, like analogies and metaphors, visual aids, stories, and examples.

Step 4: Divide the class into groups and guide them to discuss how to present the concepts of "Special economic zone" and "Made in China" in a simpler way. Groups take turns to share the results of their discussion with the whole class. Guide Ss to apply the discussed strategies in their explanation of these concepts.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

3

Special economic zone: A special economic zone is a special area within a country where different economic rules are applied. It is a "test area" for new economic policies to attract investments and encourage business and trade. A properly planned and well-managed special economic zone can bring economic transformation and spur technological advancement. For example, Shenzhen was set as a special economic zone in China in 1980. Special policies to experiment with market-oriented reforms helped Shenzhen transform from a small fishing village into a global technology hub in just a few decades.

(Note: The sample simplifies the concept of "a special economic zone" by answering two questions: "What is it?" "Why does it matter?", and using simple language so that those without much background knowledge can understand the complicated concept.)

Made in China: "Made in China" is a label for products manufactured in China. Over the years, this label has undergone a significant transformation, shifting its focus from low-cost goods to affordable high-tech and high-quality products like drones, electric vehicles, and robot products.

(Note: In cross-cultural communication, "Made in China" is much more than a label of product origin. The expression reflects the economic transformation undergone in China and the benefits Chinese products have brought to the whole world. To explain the complicated implications of this expression in a simpler way, we can break the concept into two main phases: first, as a label for low-cost goods, and then, as a symbol of high-quality, innovative products.)

Reading

Text: Breezes of change from Hainan

Background information

In 2013, the Third Plenary Session of the 18th CPC Central Committee marked China's entry into a new era of comprehensive reform and opening up. Reform efforts expanded in breadth and depth, achieving historic successes and shifting from localized trials to systematic, holistic restructuring. In 2022, the 20th National Congress of the CPC called for "further deepening reform comprehensively to advance Chinese modernization," aiming to improve and develop the socialist system with Chinese characteristics, modernize the national governance system and capacity, and advance the building of a great nation and the rejuvenation of the Chinese nation through Chinese modernization.

Facing complex domestic and international dynamics, a new wave of technological and industrial change, and rising public expectations, China formulated a strategic plan for reform grounded in the broader national and global context. It clarified the guiding principles, overall goals, and major reform measures, launching over 300 key initiatives. As a result, foundational institutional frameworks have been largely established, many sectors have undergone systemic transformation, and the modernization of governance has been significantly advanced. Meanwhile, China has adopted a more proactive opening-up strategy, building a global network of high-standard free trade zones, accelerating the development of pilot free trade zones and the Hainan Free Trade Port, and promoting the Belt and Road Initiative, strengthening its position as a major trading partner to over 150 countries and regions and fostering a broader, wider, and deeper pattern of openness.

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Notes

1 On June 1, 2020, the Chinese government released a master plan for constructing the Hannan Free Trade Port, setting a roadmap to building a high-level free trade port by 2035 and full completion by 2050. Preferential policies like tax exemptions and streamlined customs procedures were introduced in the island province to create a business-friendly environment. Over the past six years, under the leadership of the CPC Central Committee, the **Hainan Free Trade Port (FTP)** has become a new frontier for China's institutional opening up, a new hub for regional mutually beneficial cooperation, and a new engine driving economic globalization.

2 The Yangpu Port in Danzhou, Hainan is a deep-water wind-sheltered port ideal for large vessels. Established in 2007, the **Yangpu Bonded Port Area** took the lead in 2020 in the implementation of an entry and exit management system for goods to facilitate trade.

3 **Lecheng International Medical Tourism Pilot Zone** is located in Boao Town, Qionghai City, Hainan Province, close to the core area of the Boao Forum for Asia. Established in 2013, this is the only "healthcare special region" in China and it enjoys preferential policies for specially licensed healthcare, business, research, international exchanges, and other services to provide medical services not available elsewhere in the country. As a pilot zone of Hainan FTP, Lecheng is also developing international medical tourism and high-end healthcare services, and has become a testing ground for major national projects of innovation in new drugs and healthcare technologies to help improve China's healthcare system.

4 Starting on February 9, 2024, China expanded **visa-free entry** to Hainan for ordinary passport holders from 59 countries. Eligible travelers can stay up to 30 days for purposes including tourism, business, family visits, medical treatment, exhibitions, and sports competitions (excluding work and study), entering through any international port in Hainan.

5 As part of the Yazhou Bay Science and Technology City in Sanya, Hainan, the **Nanfan Scientific and Research Breeding Base** is a critical research and breeding center for crop varieties and seed industry innovation in China. According to the Construction Plan for Building the National Nanfan Silicon Valley 2023-2030, the Nanfan Breeding Base in Hainan is set to evolve into the "Silicon Valley" of China's seed industry by 2030, serving as a comprehensive hub for agricultural research, industry, and technology exchange.

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*** T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 **Spring in Hainan is a season of lush greenery and vibrant activity, where the gentle breeze carries the promise of transformation. (Para. 1)**

Note: The text opens with this vivid description of the spring scene in Hainan. Phrases like "lush greenery" and "gentle breeze" evoke visual and tactile sensations, drawing the reader into the season's beauty and vitality to enhance their connection with and understanding of the text.

2 **The FTP is not just a special economic zone; it is a dynamic hub where goods can be imported, processed, and re-exported under specific customs regulations with low or zero taxes, representing the highest level of openness in today's world. (Para. 2)**

Meaning: The FTP is more than a special economic zone – it serves as a vibrant center where goods can be brought in, manufactured, and shipped out with little or no taxes, making it one of the most open trade systems in the world today.

Note: This structure "… is not just …; it is …" is often used to emphasize that something is more significant or complex than it might initially seem. The first part "is not just" sets up a limited or superficial understanding, while the second part "it is" introduces a deeper or more important meaning, highlighting the true significance or complexity of the subject. For example:
This painting is not just a piece of art; it is a reflection of the artist's struggle and passion.

3 Even in the dead of night, the Port of Yangpu is still bustling … (Para 3.)

in the dead of night: in the middle of night 在深夜
The phone rang in the dead of night, bringing the good news we had been waiting for.

Note: Two contrasting scenes are described in this sentence – the dead of night and the bustling port. This contrast helps to grab the reader's attention and emphasize the port's non-stop operation.

4 As a pilot demonstration zone for the Hainan FTP, the Yangpu Bonded Port Area is stress-testing preferential FTP policies to prepare the whole island for independent customs operations by 2025. (Para. 4)

Meaning: The Yangpu Bonded Port Area is a testing ground for the preferential policies of the Hainan FTP. Through the implementation and evaluation of these policies in Yangpu, the initiative aims to prepare the entire island for the establishment of an independent customs system by 2025.

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stress-test:
vt. evaluate the performance or resilience of a system, process, or entity under extreme or simulated conditions（进行）压力测试
The engineers stress-tested the new software to ensure it could handle high traffic during peak usage times.

Without the hyphen, "stress test" is a noun, referring to "a method to evaluate the performance or resilience of a system, process, or entity under extreme or simulated conditions（压力测试）." For example:
Before launching the new app, the development team ran a stress test to ensure it could handle millions of users simultaneously without crashing.

5 In the year 2024, its import and export value reached RMB66.57 billion, an 8 percent year-on-year increase. (Para. 5)

year-on-year: *a.* comparing or based on comparing the same time period in successive years 同比的；较去年同期相比的.
The company reported a 5 percent year-on-year increase in sales.

Note: When the hyphens are removed, "year on year" functions as an adverb. For example, the sentence above can be rewritten as: *The company reported a 5 percent increase in sales year on year.*

6 As an international medical tourism pilot zone, the city is in sync with advanced international medical technology, equipment, and pharmaceuticals, enabling the girl to embrace the gift of sound at the optimal time. (Para. 6)

in sync with:

1) working together at the same time, at the same speed, or in the same way 与…同步的
   The robots move in sync with the beat of the music.
2) matching or in agreement 与…协调的；一致的
   Her actions were completely in sync with her values.

7 With a new policy for visa-free entry for citizens of 59 countries in play in Hainan since early 2024, Lecheng's magnetism is only growing. (Para. 8)

in play: in effect; in action 实施；活动中

*With all the new regulations in play, businesses had to adapt quickly to remain competi***tive.**

8 Through these ventures, Lecheng is on the fast track to becoming a premier global destination for medical tourism and a nexus for medical innovation, effectively catering to the health needs of both locals and international visitors. (Para. 9)

on the fast track: in a position on the quickest route to a successful position 在通往成功的快车道上

The new employee was put on the fast track to a leadership position due to her exceptional performance and innovative ideas.

nexus: *n.* [sing.] (*fml.*)

1) the central and most important point of place 中心；交叉点；汇聚焦点
   The bookstore has become something of a nexus for the downtown neighborhood.
2) a connection or network of connections between a number of people, things, or ideas （人、事物或思想之间的）关系，关联，联系，联结
   The nexus between education and economic growth is well-documented.

9 Abundant sunlight and a winterless climate all year round make Hainan a paradise for seed breeding research. (Para. 10)

Meaning: The plentiful sunlight and warm climate in Hainan create an ideal environment for seed breeding research, as they allow for faster crop growth cycles and uninterrupted agricultural experimentation.

10 China is doubling down on its commitment to opening up to the world, pushing forward development and contributing to a global narrative of an open world economy. (Para. 12)

double down (on sth.): (*usu. AmE*) continue to do sth. in an even more determined way than before 加倍努力；加大力度；更加坚定地坚持

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After seeing the success of its initial marketing campaign, the company decided to double down on its social media strategy to reach an even larger audience.

Translation

来自海南的变革之风

1 海南的春天，绿意盎然、生机勃勃，和煦的微风中蕴藏着变革的气息。这座美丽的岛屿现今已崛起为中国通向世界的重要门户。随着海南自由贸易港（FTP）的发展，这座岛屿已立于中国新一轮改革开放的最前沿，成为连接东北亚和东南亚的重要纽带。

2 海南自由贸易港不仅是一个经济特区，更是一个充满活力的枢纽。在这里，货物可依特定海关监管政策以低关税甚至零税率进口、加工、再出口，体现了当今世界最高水平的开放性。随着自贸港建设的不断推进，海南的每一天都在书写新的篇章。

凌晨 1:00，洋浦保税港区

3 即使在深夜，洋浦港依然繁忙——巨轮靠港、塔吊挥舞、五颜六色的集装箱装卸作业，码头上卡车往来穿梭，许多人昼夜不停地忙碌。“以前办理清关提货需要一到两天，现在有了简化申报政策，仅需半小时，通关效率提高了不少。”一位市场经理介绍道。

4 作为海南自贸港的试验示范区，洋浦保税港区正在进行压力测试，为全岛在 2025 年实现独立海关运作做好准备。除了简化申报程序，这里还施行了免关税和低税率等优惠政策。

5 新政策的实施让洋浦保税港区一片繁荣。截至目前，这个不到 2.3 平方公里的区域已吸引了 5,834 家企业。2024 年该区域的进出口总额达 665.7 亿元人民币，同比增长 8%。所有这些都将助力海南自贸港在本世纪中叶成为具有重要国际影响力的高水平自由贸易港。

上午 10:00，乐城国际医疗旅游先行区

6 一名四岁的小女孩正在乐城的一家医院接受手术，植入来自奥地利的最新电子助听设备。作为国际医疗旅游先行区，乐城与国际先进的医疗技术、设备和药品接轨，让这名女孩在最佳的年龄段接受移植，感受到声音的美妙。

7 乐城，这座罕见和疑难病患者的希望之城，正在进一步改革医疗审批程序。截至 2024 年底，450 多种进口药品和医疗设备获批在这里使用，造福 10 万多名患者，为他们节省大量费用，例如在美国进行人工角膜移植手术

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至少需 10 万美元，而这种手术在乐城仅需 1.5 万美元。

8 医疗技术的先进性和可及性，加上海南宜人的自然风光和气候，使乐城成为医疗旅游的热门目的地。2024 年初，海南对 59 国公民实行免签政策后，乐城的吸引力进一步增强。这座城市正在大力发展综合性医疗旅游，融合医疗、健康与休闲，以吸引更多人前来体验其卓越服务。

9 通过这些努力，乐城正在快速成为全球医疗旅游的首选目的地和医疗创新的核心之地，切实满足国内和国际游客的医疗健康需求。

下午 2:00，南繁科研育种基地

10 充足的阳光和全年无冬的气候，使海南成为育种研究的天堂。在海南的南繁科研育种基地，种子专家们正在观察实验田中最近播种的玉米种子——这些种子远从巴西跨洋而来。

11 南繁科研育种基地正随着自贸港的发展而不断进化。依托自由贸易港这一国际化通道，南繁的科学家们有更多优质种源可选。得益于技术进步，种子专家现在可以远程收集并分析作物整个生长周期的实时数据，加快研究进程及其实际应用。大幅度的税收优惠和高额的补助吸引了投资，也引得研究机构和知名种业公司纷纷入驻。到 2030 年，一个集研究、生产、销售、科技交流及成果转化为一体的“南繁硅谷”将全面建成，造福中国并助力解决全球粮食安全问题。

12 太阳再次升起，为海南岛蓬勃发展的景象披上金色的光芒。海南自贸港的建设正如火如荼，开启了海南改革开放之旅的新篇章。中国正加大对外开放力度，推动发展，积极参与全球开放型经济体系的构建。

校园资料仓

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) a pilot demonstration zone
2) tariff exemptions
3) medical approval procedures
4) visa-free entry
5) high-quality seeds
6) tax breaks

2

1 having attracted 5,834 enterprises and achieving an import and export value of RMB66.57 billion, marking a 8 percent year-on-year increase.

2 with cutting-edge medical technology, relatively lower costs for medical treatment, a beautiful ecological environment, and a pleasant climate.

3 integrating research, production, sales, sci-tech exchanges, and achievement transformation.

Intercultural communication skill

Teaching suggestions

- Help Ss to understand that a rich context is crucial for communication across cultural boundaries. Guide Ss to read through the illustrations on situation-based narratives in the textbook.
- Invite some Ss to explain the two example strategies used in the Yangpu story in their own words.
- Guide Ss to discuss other possible strategies to create a rich context, for example:
  - Name cities, landmarks, or regions, or describe the cultural or geographical significance of the location.
  - Describe people, objects, or events with sensory details, or use sensory details to evoke a sense of place.
  - Share personal anecdotes or experiences that evoke universal emotions.
  - Structure the narrative in a logical, easy-to-follow sequence.
  - Describe characters' roles, motivations, and emotions.
  - …
- Divide Ss into pairs and guide them to discuss how the author of the text engages the audience through a situation-based narrative in the Lecheng and Nanfan stories.

*** Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

Sample answers

Just like the description of the Por of Yangpu, both the Lecheng and Nanfan stories begin with a scene at a specific time.

Lecheng International Medical Tourism Pilot Zone: Instead of a bustling view with multiple elements, the Lecheng story begins with a simple narration about a four-year-old girl undergoing a hearing device implantation surgery. The mentioning of the details – the girl's age, the device from Austria, and the optimal time – fosters the

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readers' empathy and helps them to understand why Lecheng is called "a city of hope."

Nanfan Scientific and Research Breeding Base: The text introduces the Nanfan Scientific and Research Breeding Base with a vivid scene of researchers observing seeds. Details like "the corn seeds," "recently planted," and "traveled all the way across the ocean from Brazil," help to immerse the readers in the scene and helpthem to understand the effect of the "opening up."

Language in focus

Reference answers

1

1 approval

2 exemptions

3 has enacted

4 luring

5 hefty

6 optimal

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2

1 Even in the dead of night

2 shuttle back and forth

3 host international cultural exchange events every year

4 needs to be in sync with

5 is doubling down on language education and talent exchange programs

6 on the fast track

3

As a university student, I have witnessed the profound changes brought about by reform and opening up. With a series of policies encouraging innovation and promoting development now in play, society continues to radiate new vitality. Reform and opening up is now in full swing, creating unprecedented opportunities for young people to thrive. In this hopeful new era, I believe that as long as we maintain our spirit of endeavor and couple our efforts with the opportunities granted by the times, we will surely achieve our life goals and contribute our youthful strength to national development.

Critical thinking

Sample answers

1

In addition to the construction of the Hainan Free Trade Port, a series of significant measures have also been implemented to deepen the reform and opening up in the new era. These reforms focus on refining institutional frameworks and operational mechanisms to support innovation, fairness, and sustainable development, and to promote a high-standard socialist market economy system. A rural revitalization strategy is introduced to improve rural infrastructure, promote agricultural modernization, and create a more balanced economic structure. Funding is set up to promote scientific and technological self-reliance. Measures are taken to boost domestic consumption. The domestic reforms are accompanied by stronger opening-up initiatives, such as the construction of the Guangdong-Hong Kong-Macao Greater Bay Area and the high-quality development of the Belt and Road Initiative.

These new measures differ from previous ones. First, greater emphasis is placed on high-quality development, focusing on economic growth that is efficient, inclusive, and sustainable, rather than merely on GDP growth. Second, innovation-driven strategies are encouraged, moving away from reliance on low-cost labor and resource-intensive industries. The new measures leverage science, technology, and innovation as the primary engines of economic growth. What's more, economic growth is achieved together with the minimization of environmental degradation, carbon emissions reduction, and the sustainable use of natural resources.

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2

These measures to further advance the modernization of China's governance system and capabilities in the new era reflect the new development concepts that are in sync with the new national and international situation.

First, reform in the new era, as a comprehensive endeavor, covers all aspects and fields, including the economy, politics, culture, society, ecological civilization, national defense, and military reform, as well as the reform of the governance system of the Communist Party of China. Its overall goal is to improve and develop the system of socialism with Chinese characteristics and to advance the modernization of China's system and capacity for governance. Under this overarching goal, specific sub-goals have been set for deepening the reform across various sectors, ensuring that different reforms are integrated into an organic whole.

Second, reform in the new era is closely intertwined with high-level opening up, with the two processes reinforcing each other to achieve greater development in the new historical conditions. Concrete plans have been made for building a higher-standard open economy, with an emphasis on promoting broader, wider, and deeper

opening up, and advancing institutional opening up in areas such as rules, regulations, management, and standards.

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Exploring the world

Thanks to its continuous reform efforts and opening-up policies, China continues to achieve sustained growth in the dynamic world. Similarly, many other countries are striving to forge their own paths to progress. For example, the countries in the African continent are making collective efforts under the AfCFTA framework to establish a unified market for goods, services, investment, and people across the member states. This initiative aims to facilitate intra-African trade, promote regional integration, drive economic diversification, and ultimately deliver greater growth and prosperity to all member countries.

The key points focus on helping Ss understand the challenges involved in achieving African economic integration and the key strategies to address them, including reducing trade barriers and harmonizing policies. The difficult points lie in guiding Ss to grasp the background and significance of the AfCFTA.

Africa's commitment to free trade, the elimination of trade barriers, and multilateral cooperation aligns with the broader context of economic globalization – an inevitable and unstoppable trend driving global progress. These efforts can be compared to China's unwavering support for economic globalization, its emphasis on safeguarding free trade, resolving trade disputes through dialogue and consultation, and promoting collective action to ensure the stability and fairness of the global trade system. Meanwhile, counter-globalization trends, such as the rise of protectionism and unilateral actions like the US trade wars, should be critically examined.

校园资料包

Text: New horizons in African trade

Background information

Africa, the second-largest continent in terms of both land area and population, comprises over 50 recognized independent countries with significantly uneven levels of development, with huge gaps between high-income, middle-income, and low-income countries. To promote unity, development, and peace across the African continent, the African Union (AU) was established in 2002. Inspired by the vision of "an integrated, prosperous, and peaceful Africa, driven by its own citizens and representing a dynamic force in the international arena," the AU launched Agenda 2063 in 2015 as a strategic framework for the socio-economic transformation of the continent.

The African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA), which was established in 2018, came into force in 2019 and was officially launched in 2021, as one of the flagship projects of Agenda 2063. The AfCFTA aims to create a single continental market for goods and services, fostering regional cooperation, reducing trade barriers, and promoting inclusive growth. By addressing disparities through policies that encourage industrialization, infrastructure development, and economic diversification, the

AfCFTA represents a pioneering effort by African countries to integrate their economies and strengthen their global competitiveness.

Notes

1 The **World Bank Group** is the largest multilateral development institution in the world, dedicated to helping developing countries eliminate poverty and promote sustainable development. Headquartered in Washington, DC, the capital of the United States, the World Bank consists of five member organizations: the International Bank for Reconstruction and Development (IBRD), the International Development Association (IDA), the International Finance Corporation (IFC), the Multilateral Investment Guarantee Agency (MIGA), and the International Centre for Settlement of Investment Disputes (ICSID).

2 As the pillars of the AU, the **Regional Economic Communities (RECs)** are regional groupings of African states that were formed prior to the launch of the AU. The REGs aim to facilitate regional economic integration between members of the individual regions. The AU recognizes eight RECs:

- Arab Maghreb Union (UMA)
- Common Market for Eastern and Southern Africa (COMESA)
- Community of Sahel–Saharan States (CEN–SAD)
- East African Community (EAC)
- Economic Community of Central African States (ECCAS)
- Economic Community of West African States (ECOWAS)
- Intergovernmental Authority on Development (IGAD)
- Southern African Development Community (SADC)

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***T can guide Ss to study the multimodal annotations in the digital textbook on Ucampus.**

Language points

1 **The supermarket shelves in Freetown, Sierra Leone are bursting at the seams with imported goods, ranging from Chinese toothpicks and Dutch toilet paper to French sugar and Swiss chocolates. (Para. 1)**

be bursting at the seams: be very full of people or things 过于拥挤；过满
The stadium was bursting at the seams as thousands of fans gathered to watch the championship match.

Note: This sentence is a good example of a situation-based narrative. The detailed description of imported goods from various countries helps readers to visualize the supermarket shelves in the African city.

2 So why do retailers source them from far-off countries instead of local producers? (Para. 1)

source (from): *vt*. obtain sth. from a particular place 从…获取
The chef prefers to source produce from local farmers to get the freshest ingredients for his dishes.

Note: This rhetorical question is asked to draw the readers' attention to the problem the AfCFTA tries to address.

3 The answer lies in a patchwork of trade regulations and tariffs that tend to make intra-African commerce costly, inconsistent, and cumbersome. (Para. 1)

Note: Here the word "patchwork" refers to a fragmented and inconsistent system of trade regulations and tariffs; "costly" reflects the high expenses associated with cross-border trade; "inconsistent" indicates the lack of uniformity, stability, or predictability; and "cumbersome" refers to the complex and time-consuming processes involved in moving goods across borders. Together, these words explain the barriers for intra-African trade and highlight the need for reforms promoted by the AfCFTA.

4 … it represents 1.3 billion people and a collective GDP of US$3 trillion across a geographic area as vast as the United States, China, India, and much of Western Europe put together. (Para. 2)

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Note: This sentence compares the size of the African continent to the size of the US, China, India, and Western European countries together. This helps the readers to understand how big the continent is and how important its sustainable growth would be.

5 The World Bank estimates that the AfCFTA could increase the continent's real income by up to 9 percent and lift 50 million people out of extreme poverty by 2035 if all policies under consideration are adopted. (Para. 4)

Note: The phrase "real income" is a term in finance and economics referring to the money earned by a person, company, government, etc. over a particular period of time that is calculated by taking into account the effect of inflation. The term "real income" reflects the purchasing power of the income. For example, we can say "Even though she got a pay raise, her real income fell because prices rose faster." On the contrary, "nominal income" is the raw amount of money earned before any adjustments for inflation or changes in the cost of living.

6 However, turning the aspiration into reality is a marathon, not a sprint, and Africa still faces myriad challenges. (Para. 6)

Note: The two opposite words "marathon" and "sprint" are used metaphorically to show the nature of the effort required to turn aspirations into reality. "Marathon" implies a long-term, sustained effort, while "not a sprint" emphasizes that it cannot be

achieved quickly or easily, requiring patience and resilience.

The expression "… is a marathon, not a sprint" is a common metaphor used to emphasize the need for endurance, patience, and sustained effort. For example:
Building a successful business is a marathon, not a sprint.
Life is a marathon, not a sprint.

7 The wealthier African nations, who are likely to be the first to benefit from freer trade, should take responsibility and catalyze opportunities for the economically weaker states. (Para. 7)

catalyze: *vt*. make sth. start happening or start being successful 催动…发生（或成功）
His inspiring speech catalyzed a wave of enthusiasm among the team, leading to a successful project launch.

8 That, in turn, will create demand for components and raw materials from other African countries such as Zambia, a major copper producer, or the Democratic Republic of the Congo, where cobalt for lithium batteries could be mined and processed. (Para. 7)

Note: The rise of electric vehicles (EVs) has significantly increased the demand for copper and cobalt. Compared to traditional internal combustion engine vehicles, EVs use substantially more copper for batteries, motors, and charging infrastructure, and cobalt for high-performance lithium-ion batteries.

9 While these reforms are crucial, the heavy lifting is still to come … (Para. 9)

Meaning: Although these reforms are essential, the real challenge still lies ahead.

the heavy lifting: most of the work involved in sth.; the most difficult part of a task （工作）最主要的方面；（任务）最困难的部分
The heavy lifting in our project involves coordinating the complex logistics and ensuring all stakeholders are aligned.

Translation

非洲贸易的新天地

1 塞拉利昂弗里敦的超市货架上摆满了进口商品，从中国的牙签、荷兰的卫生纸到法国的糖和瑞士的巧克力，应有尽有。然而，这些商品很多也在邻国生产，如加纳、摩洛哥、尼日利亚和南非。那么，为什么零售商选择从遥远的国家采购，而不购买非洲当地生产商的产品呢？答案在于错综复杂的贸易法规和关税，这些法规和关税往往会使非洲内部的贸易成本高、不稳定且流程烦琐。

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2 非洲贸易一体化长期困于边境管理不断恶化，运输系统效率低下，以及各国间法律和政策不一致。2019 年启动的非洲大陆自由贸易区（AfCFTA）点燃了希望的灯塔。迄今 55 个非洲联盟成员国中已有 54 个批准该协议，代表了 13 亿人口和总计 3 万亿美元的国内生产总值，覆盖的地理面积相当于美国、中国、印度和大部分西欧的面积总和。

3 非洲自贸区旨在建立一个商品和服务的统一市场，实现资本和商务人员的自由流动。加入非洲自贸区的国家必须承诺 2034 年前取消至少 97%的商品的关税。消除关税和非关税壁垒将减少贸易成本，促进非洲内部贸易。统一市场还将使非洲国家增强自身的工业基础，转变经济结构，提升其在全球舞台上的地位。

4 创建一个单一市场具有巨大的潜力。很多相对未开发的领域充满了机遇，例如服务贸易——全球增长最快、不断提供新就业岗位的行业，以及电子商务。世界银行估计，如果所有非洲自贸区拟议中的政策被采纳，到 2035 年，非洲自贸区将有助于非洲大陆提高多达 9%的实际收入，帮助 5,000 万人摆脱极端贫困。

5 自 2021 年非洲自贸区正式实施以来，非洲大陆各国的协同努力已经取得了积极成果。尽管全球经济放缓，非洲内部贸易总值在 2023 年仍增长至 1,922 亿美元，继 2022 年 10.9%的显著增长后，又提升了 3.2%。

6 然而，将愿景转化为现实将是一场马拉松，而非短跑。非洲仍面临许多挑战。例如，一些国家长期受到冲突的困扰，边境程序可能烦琐耗时。此外，非洲大陆上使用的超过 42 种之多的货币造成交易困难，每年给贸易商带来约 50 亿美元的额外成本。

7 非洲各国人均国内生产总值差异极大，从布隆迪的 221 美元到毛里求斯的 9,100 美元不等，要融合在一起并非易事。但非洲已经迈出了第一步——其八个区域经济共同体可以作为构建非洲自贸区的基石。那些更富有的非洲国家可能最先受益于自由贸易，应当承担责任，为经济较弱的国家创造机会。以汽车生产为例，非洲的三大汽车制造地——埃及、摩洛哥和南非 ——将受益于非洲汽车市场开放。这将继而催生对其他非洲国家零部件和原材料的需求，如 主要产铜国赞比亚，或者可为锂电池开采加工钴矿的刚果民主共和国。

8 此外，为了充分实现非洲自贸区的潜力，还需要进行配套改革。非洲各国需要升级物流，扫清数字商务障碍，并改善营商环境，如提高监管透明度等。

授课资料

9 尽管这些改革至关重要，但最艰巨的任务还在后面——协调各国关于知识产权、投资保护、电子商务和竞争政策等领域的国内法规。这对于实现预期的就业、收入和外商直接投资的增长至关重要。更重要的是，非洲自贸区必须得到非洲大小企业的支持，正是这些企业将利用协议所提供的机会，推动就业和经济增长。

10 建立一个自贸区并非易事，其他大洲已有先例。但非洲的商业、政府和民间各界领导人已展示出推动这一项目的决心。这个全球最大的自贸区向国际投资者发出了强烈信号，表明非洲正开放市场，实施统一的贸易和投资规则。非洲大陆自由贸易区协议有望成为非洲经济发展的游戏规则改变者，并为非洲的未来点燃希望。

Reading and understanding

Reference answers

1

1) a single continental market
2) free movement
3) 54
4) removing tariffs
5) value of intra-African trade
6) game changer

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2

Potential benefits

1 Para. 3
2 Para. 3
3 Para. 4
4 Para. 3
5 Para. 4
6 Para. 3
7 Para. 3

Challenges

8 Para. 7

9 Para. 9

10 Para. 6

11 Para. 6

12 Para. 6

Language in focus

1 Complete the paragraph with the correct form of the words given below.

constrain	complementary	deteriorate	feat	knit
leverage	impediment	reap	transparency	untapped

The African Continental Free Trade Area (AfCFTA) represents a historic 1) _____ in the continent's journey toward economic integration. Aiming to create a(n) 2) _____ market, AfCFTA seeks the elimination of tariffs and other barriers that 3) _____ intra-African trade. In doing so, it leverages Africa's booming industries and 4) _____ economic strengths, enabling the countries to 5) _____ greater benefits from their collective potential. With a focus on improving regulatory 6) _____ and consistency, AfCFTA helps 7) _____ together diverse economies, fostering stronger connections and mutual growth. Although challenges such as 8)_____ infrastructure and multiple currencies persist, AfCFTA opens doors to vast, previously 9) _____ markets, creating new opportunities for businesses and entrepreneurs alike. By 10) _____ the collective efforts and cooperation of African countries, AfCFTA is unlocking a new era of prosperity and resilience for the continent.

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Reference answers

1) feat

2) unified

3) constrain

4) complementary

5) reap

6) transparency

7) knit

8) deteriorating

9) untapped

10) leveraging

2 Match the phrases in Column A with their definitions in Column B.

A	B
1 a case in point	a) a complex and confusing network or arrangement of things
2 a maze of	b) an example of the situation or behavior that sb. is talking about
3 be bursting at the seams	c) be very full of people or things
4 carry through	d) increase or raise sth., usu. referring to prices, costs, or demand
5 cut down	e) obtain sth. from a particular place
6 drive up	f) reduce or decrease the amount, size, or number of sth.
7 kick off	g) start or begin sth., often used for events, activities, or projects
8 source from	h) complete sth. successfully

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Reference answers

1 b 2 a 3 c 4 h 5 f 6 d 7 g 8 e

3 Complete the sentences with the correct form of the phrases in Column A.

1 The government _____ significant reforms to ensure that each phase of development was effectively implemented.

2 The city's financial district _____ with new businesses and investors, reflecting the rapid development in the region.

3 Many tech companies have their components _____ overseas suppliers to reduce costs.

4 The new trade agreements have _____ demand for local products, leading to an increase in exports and boosting the national economy.

5 Industrial automation inevitably displaces low-skilled labor; _____ is the German manufacturing belt's shift from traditional workshops to AI-driven production hubs.

6 To improve resource management, the government implemented policies to _____ on waste and ensure more sustainable economic growth.

7 The government's new economic initiative will _____ next year, aiming to

boost small businesses and create more jobs across the country.

8 The healthcare sector has seen significant improvements after _____ inefficient legislation was repealed.

Reference answers

1 carried through

2 is bursting at the seams

3 sourced from

4 driven up

5 a case in point

6 cut down

7 kick off

8 a maze of

Live interview

Teaching suggestions

One objective of this activity is to deepen Ss' understanding of the free trade efforts, develop their ability to use the English language through turns of questions and answers, and sharpen their communicative skills to participate in dialogues.

- T briefly introduces the scenario, purpose, and roles for the activity, and divides the class into three groups.
- T assigns a role to each group randomly, and guides each group to prepare based on their assigned roles:
  - Interviewer: Develop key questions, anticipate possible answers, and plan strategies to facilitate discussion.
  - Chinese representative: Prepare answers showcasing China's free trade practices, outcomes, and collaboration opportunities with Africa.
  - African representative: Prepare answers showcasing Africa's free trade practices, outcomes, and collaboration opportunities with China.
- (Optional) T rearranges Ss into groups of three with each member from different roles, and holds parallel live interviews in the same room. Maximum participation can be achieved with every student playing a role in a group.
- T invites one member of the interviewer team to host the interview. Several

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members of the Chinese and African representatives are invited to the stage for a live interview show. The other Ss take part as the audience who might be invited by the interviewer to ask questions.

- The interviewer leads the session, asks questions, and facilitates discussion. Representatives respond to the questions and can ask each other questions.
- T asks Ss to write a reflection note, summarizing the key messages covered in the interview, and suggesting improvements for future interviews.
- T provides constructive feedback, focusing on intercultural communication skills and the depth and relevance of the discussion content.

Sample answers

Interviewer: Thank you all for joining this discussion today! To start, let's talk about free trade in China and Africa. What are the similarities and differences in the free trade practices in China and Africa, and how do they contribute to economic growth?

Chinese youth representative: Both regions focus on reducing trade barriers and fostering economic growth. For example, China's Hainan Free Trade Port implements zero tariffs and streamlined customs procedures, while Africa's AfCFTA eliminates tariffs and harmonizes regulations to boost intra-African trade. However, the scale is different – China's initiatives focus on specific regions like Hainan, whereas AfCFTA involves 54 countries, making coordination more complex. Additionally, China's infrastructure is well-established, while Africa is still building the necessary systems to support free trade.

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African youth representative: I agree. Both aim to promote regional integration and connectivity, recognizing that these are key to unlocking economic potential. However, Africa's diversity in legal systems and economic development stages presents unique challenges. Despite this, the AfCFTA is fostering cooperation among nations, while China's targeted strategies provide valuable lessons for tailoring policies to local conditions.

Interviewer: Thank you! Now, let's discuss the outcomes and future collaboration. What have been the key achievements, and how can China and Africa work together to advance free trade?

Chinese youth representative: Including the Hainan FTP, China has established 21 free trade zones across the country, playing a pivotal role in enhancing foreign trade, driving economic structural transformation and upgrading, and deepening integration between domestic and global markets. One collaboration opportunity is infrastructure development – China's expertise in building transportation networks can help Africa strengthen trade corridors under the AfCFTA framework.

African youth representative: Africa's AfCFTA is increasing intra-African trade

and bringing nations closer together. Collaboration in agriculture is another opportunity – Africa's resources combined with China's advanced farming technologies can enhance productivity and create value-added products for global markets.

Interviewer: Thank you both for your insights! It's clear that free trade opens up huge opportunities for collaboration between China and Africa, paving the way for shared growth and prosperity.

Sample question bank:

1 What did China do to promote free trade?

2 What has China achieved in promoting free trade?

3 What lessons and experiences can China offer to Africa?

4 What can China learn from Africa's experience in the building of a united market across the continent?

5 Why do African countries want a single market across the continent?

6 Why is free trade between African countries important?

7 What has the AfCFTA achieved so far?

8 What lessons and experiences can Africa offer to China?

9 What can Africa learn from China's reform and opening up?

10 What similarities do China and African countries share in their efforts for growth?

11 What are the differences between China and Africa in their exploration of the right path of development?

12 What are some of the biggest challenges Africa faces in implementing free trade agreements, and how can China offer support in addressing these challenges?

13 What are some potential areas for future collaboration between China and Africa?

14 How can young people from China and Africa contribute to strengthening the ties between the two regions?

校园资料仓

Communicating with the world

Additional notes

The key objective of an expository speech is to inform the audience about the chosen topic. To ensure good understanding from the audience, the speaker should first select and organize the target messages based on the audience's background knowledge about the issue. T can guide Ss to review the video and the two texts in the unit and discuss how to simplify and adapt information about China's ongoing reform and opening up to suit the audience's knowledge level. Another important consideration is how to present the selected messages. T can guide Ss to use situation-based narratives in their talk to make their speech more engaging. An engaging expository speech requires the effective use of public speaking skills. T can guide Ss to refine their speeches by incorporating techniques they have learned, such as crafting a good hook, asking interactive questions, presenting a specific scenario, and delivering a powerful ending.

For evaluation of the speech, consider the following perspectives:

- **Content:** Clearly explain China's reform and opening up and the Hainan FTP with accurate facts, engaging cases, and insightful comments.
- **Structure:** Develop a complete speech with good logical flow, transitioning smoothly from greeting the audience and a hook to a brief overview, then to the Hainan FTP and a natural conclusion.
- **Audience connection:** Engage the audience with a strong hook and interactive questions, relating to international audiences' interests.
- **Language:** Use concise and vivid language appropriate for a speech.
- **Cultural sensitivity:** Balances pride with inclusivity, addressing stereotyping and misconceptions.

***Remind Ss to access the video micro-lecture in the digital textbook to learn more about the skill on Ucampus.**

校园资料室

Sample answers

Distinguished guests and fellow students,

Good morning!

Imagine this: You are walking along a fine sandy beach, with crystal-clear waves gently massaging your feet. How do you feel? Relaxed, comfortable? Can you associate this place with the forefront of China's reform and opening up? This tropical paradise is now a testing ground for the future of open economies.

Hainan's transformation mirrors China's 40-year journey from poverty to prosperity. In 1978, China opened its door with a bold experiment: setting up special economic zones like Shenzhen. Under the new policies, foreign investment, technology, and trade flooded in. In 2001, China joined the WTO with all kinds of goods produced and shipped to almost every corner of the world.

The results? Small villages like Shenzhen are now modern cities with skyscrapers rising into the clouds; China has grown into the world's second-largest economy, and the whole world benefits from China's products. But the real miracle is that over 800 million Chinese people were lifted out of poverty – that's like lifting every person in Europe twice. These achievements show the power of reform: not just growth, but transformation.

Now, meet Hainan 2.0! In 2018, the Hainan Island became the Free Trade Port with policies bolder than Shenzhen's early days – tax incentives, simplified procedures, tariff exemptions, visa-free entry – all these show the highest level of openness in today's world. By 2035, Hainan envisions becoming an international trade hub comparable to Singapore and Dubai. During a short tour in Hainan, we could explore its emerging potential: Will Haikou's tech parks or Sanya's cruise ports lead the way in positioning Hainan as the "next Shenzhen"?

Many of you come from countries like Kenya, Nigeria, or Egypt – places that are actively building your own trade blocs like the AfCFTA. During this study tour, let's explore Hainan's policies – examining the successes and the challenges – and discuss how similar strategies could be adopted for cities like Lagos, Nairobi, or Dhaka. What might work? What might need rethinking? China's development experience offers one perspective in a broader global conversation. While our reforms have significantly transformed our economy, your nations have the potential to innovate and chart unique paths forward.

Hainan proves that even paradise can innovate. As future leaders, you're not just witnesses to China's story – you're authors of your own. So let's dive in, question openly, and connect deeply. The next chapter of global growth starts here, with us.

Thank you – and let the journey begin!

校园资料仓

Self-reflection

Understanding China	1	I can list the major steps in China's reform and opening up since 1978.
	2	I can describe China's achievements brought by the reform and opening up in the past decades.
	3	I can explain the approaches Hainan has taken in China's new round of reform and opening up.
	4	I can report the initial achievements of the Hainan FTP.
	5	I can illustrate the impact of the Hainan FTP on China and the world.
Exploring the world	1	I can explain what the AfCFTA is.
	2	I can talk about the potential benefits the AfCFTA might bring.
	3	I can analyze the potential challenges the AfCFTA member countries have to face.
Communicating with the world	1	I can use a situation-based narrative to hook the audience in my speech.
	2	I can simplify complex concepts in my speech.

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